

INVENTING WORDS

[User Manual](#)[v0.8.1-beta](#)

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Chapter 1 — What is Gombro?

Gombro is a writing machine centered on one thing: the human invention of the word.

Not the polished word. Not the optimized word. The **word in motion** — following the drift of thought, the accident of order, the surprise of what comes next when nothing is forced.

There is no AI here. No autocomplete, no suggestions, no invisible hand steering your sentences toward the probable. Gombro is a tool entirely at the service of the writer's own flow.

Every writing session in Gombro is a **jazz improvisation** — a session in the musical sense. You open the instrument, you play, you stop. What you left behind is a record of the session: raw, alive, retrievable.

The writers who would have used Gombro

Gombro is the word processor that Kafka would have used to fragment his diaries and resolve them. That Jacques Vaché would have used to cut up letters he never sent.

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Gombrowicz would have used to shuffle chapters until the form itself became the argument. That Joyce would have used to draft *Nighttown* in disconnected bursts and recombine them at 3am. That Néstor Sánchez would have used to write *Siberia Blues* one splinter at a time. That Philip K. Dick would have used to write *The Man in the High Castle* or *VALIS* — novels where reality itself refuses to hold still.

What Gombro is not

- It is not a word processor for final formatting
- It is not a project manager with folders, statuses, or deadlines
- It does not connect to the cloud or any external service
- **It contains no AI of any kind**

The two core concepts

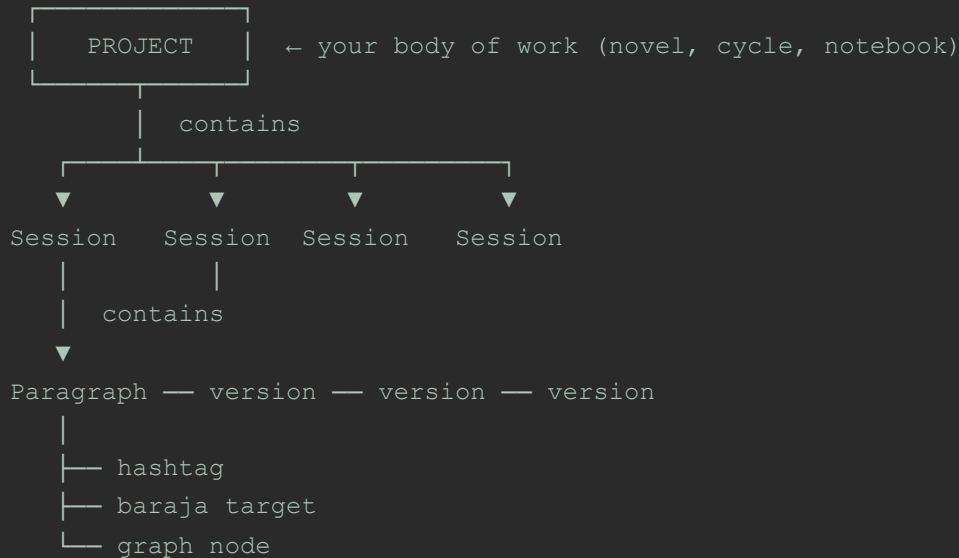
CONCEPT	WHAT IT IS
Project	A container for a body of work — a novel, a story cycle, a notebook
Session	A single improvisation inside a project — a scene, a fragment, a drift

Chapter 2 — Getting Started

The interface at a glance

[+] [↑]

How it all connects:



- **Top bar** — language toggle [EN] and help button [?]
- **Explorer** — left panel, lists your sessions
- **Editor** — center/right panel, where you write
- **CmdBar** — bottom panel, the command terminal. Open with : or /. Press Ctrl+T for the floating palette.

Step 1 — Create your first project

Press : to open the CmdBar, then type:

```
create project Don Quixote
```

Press Enter. The project is created and becomes active.

Step 2 — Create your first session

Press Ctrl+N, or open the CmdBar and type:

↑ top

Step 3 — Start writing

Click on the Editor area and start typing. That's it.

Key things to know

WHAT	HOW
Open the CmdBar	<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>
Create a session	<code>Ctrl+N</code> or <code>new <name></code> in CmdBar
Open Help	<code>[?]</code> button, <code>F1</code> , or <code>help</code> in CmdBar
Switch language	<code>[EN]</code> chip in top bar or <code>lang es</code> in CmdBar
Close any modal	<code>Esc</code>

Chapter 3 — The Editor

The Editor is where everything happens. It is intentionally bare — no toolbars, no formatting buttons, no rulers. Just the text and you.

Each block of text separated by a blank line is a **paragraph** — the fundamental unit in Gombro. Paragraphs are stored, versioned, shuffled, and tagged individually.

Context menu

Right-click anywhere in the editor to open the context menu:

Undo

↑ top

Select all

Cut / Copy / Paste

Insert

Add variant

Reveal in Binder

Shuffle (Baraja)

Paragraph versions

Sentence Mode

Toggle with `sentence mode` in the CmdBar. Every `.` isolates the current sentence — one at a time, the rest disappears. Type, hit period, lock and continue.

SENTENCE MODE — only one sentence visible at a time:

Chapter One	[sentence mode] [Select all]	
.....		← locked
An occasional stew, beef more often than lamb, hash most nights, eggs and abstinence on Saturdays.		← active
.....		← locked

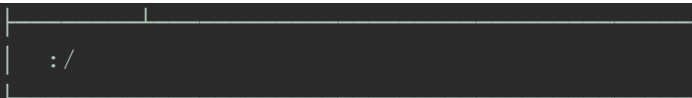
Type → hit `[.]` → sentence locks → next one opens

Layout — three panels

Gombro has three permanent zones:

EXPLORER	EDITOR	
session1	text...	
session2		
session3		

↑ top



← CmdBar / terminal

- **Explorer** (left) — session list for the active project.
- **Editor** (center/right) — writing area.
- **CmdBar** (bottom) — command terminal. Open with `:` or `/`. Press `Ctrl+T` for the floating palette.

Split Panel

You can split the editor into two panels to view two sessions simultaneously — or mirror the same session from two vantage points.

The split buttons are in the editor's top bar:

-  — horizontal split (left / right)
-  — vertical split (top / bottom)
- Clicking the active button again closes the split.

SPLIT VIEW (horizontal)

EXPLORER	PANEL 1	PANEL 2
session1	text...	text...
session2		

Mirror mode

When both panels show the same session, they act as a mirror: any change in one appears instantly in the other. Saving to the database happens on its own rhythm (debounce), independent of the mirror.

Independent panels

If you open a different session in the second panel (by clicking the Explorer while focused on that panel), each panel saves and edits its session independently.

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Locking a panel

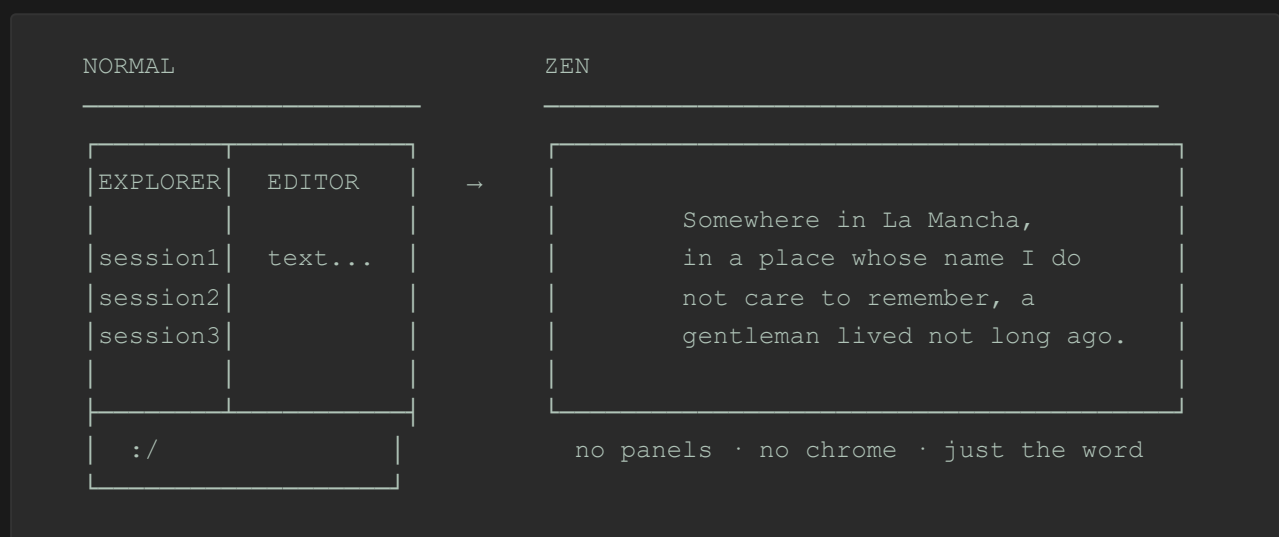
The  lock icon in each panel's header pins the session — Explorer clicks won't change it.

Closing the split

When closing, the focused panel becomes the single editor. Its content is applied to the remaining panel instantly, without waiting for the DB.

Zen Mode

Expands the editor to full screen. Toggle with `zen` in the CmdBar, or press `Esc` when idle.



Keyboard reference

ACTION	HOW
Open CmdBar	<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>
Floating palette	<code>Ctrl+T</code>
Floating search	<code>Ctrl+F</code>
New session	<code>Ctrl+N</code>
Open today's diary session	<code>Ctrl+D</code>
Session post-it	<code>F4</code>
Help	<code>F1</code>

↑ top

Select all text	<code>[Select all]</code> button or right-click
Toggle Sentence Mode	<code>sentence mode</code> in CmdBar
Toggle Zen Mode	<code>zen</code> in CmdBar · <code>Esc</code> from idle
Close CmdBar / search / activate Zen	<code>Esc</code> (cascading)

Chapter 4 — The CmdBar

Press `:` or `/` to open. Press `Esc` to close. Every command works in English and Spanish.

Writing

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>new <name></code> · <code>nuevo <nombre></code>	Create a new session
<code>sentence mode</code> · <code>modo frase</code>	Toggle sentence mode
<code>zen</code>	Toggle zen mode

Projects

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>create project <name></code>	Create a new project
<code>open</code> · <code>view projects</code>	Show the project list

Search

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
---------	--------------

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search <term>

Search across all sessions

search <term> in phrases

Search showing individual sentences

Export

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>compile</code> · <code>compilar</code>	Export all sessions to .docx
<code>compile</code> <name>	Export with custom filename

Interface

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>help</code> · <code>ayuda</code>	Open the help modal
<code>lang en</code> · <code>lang es</code>	Switch interface language

Chapter 5 — The Explorer

The Explorer is the left panel — your session list, your binder. Every session in the active project lives here.

- `[+]` — create a new session (at the end of the list)
- `[↑]` — import a file (.md, .docx, .txt)
- The stats at the bottom show totals for the active project

Adding a session or paragraph at position

Right-click a session or a paragraph in the expanded outline to insert new content **directly below** the clicked item:

↑ top

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Right-click session → Add session below	Creates a new session immediately below that session, ready to rename
Right-click paragraph (outline) → Add paragraph below	Inserts an empty paragraph below — shows "nuevo párrafo" in the explorer until you type

Reordering paragraphs

In the expanded outline you can reorder paragraphs with drag & drop, just like sessions:

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Drag paragraph in outline → drop at new position	Moves the paragraph, saves to DB and reloads the editor

Navigating to a paragraph

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Click paragraph in outline	Cursor jumps to that paragraph in the editor, ready to type
<code>Enter</code> in the editor	Creates a new paragraph below the cursor (same as "Add paragraph below")

Project stats

STAT	WHAT IT MEASURES
Days	How many days you've written in this project
Words	Total word count across all sessions
Sentences	Total sentence count
Commas	Proxy for sentence complexity and rhythm

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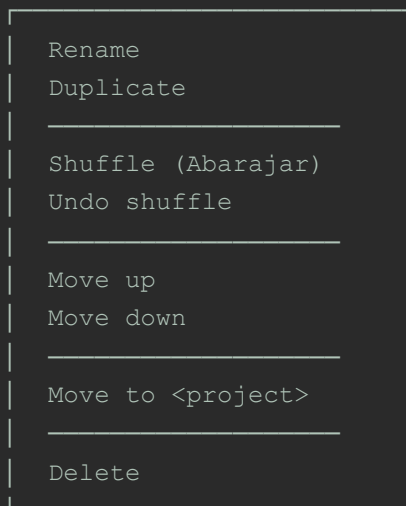
Multi-select

You can select multiple sessions in the Explorer at once:

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>Ctrl+click</code>	Add or remove a session from the selection
<code>Shift+click</code>	Select the range from the last clicked session to this one
<code>Delete</code>	Delete all selected sessions at once

Session context menu

Right-click any session:



Move up / Move down — reorder sessions within the project. The order persists. You can also **drag and drop** sessions directly in the list.

Chapter 6 — Search and Collections

Search works across the full text of every paragraph in the active project.

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search gentleman

Use phrase mode for sentence-level results:

search gentleman in phrases

Collections

A Collection is a saved search. After any search, click + **Save as collection**. Name it, save it, and it appears in the Explorer — one click to re-run.

Sessions	[↑]
La Mancha	
The Knight	
Stew and Income	
The Housekeeper	
COLLECTIONS	
▶ The Gentleman arc	
▶ Food & income	
▶ Names debate	

← saved searches, always one click away

Chapter 7 — Paragraph Versions

Every time a paragraph changes, Gombro keeps a copy automatically. This is a per-paragraph history — not undo.

Access: right-click a paragraph → *Paragraph versions*, or hover a session in the Explorer → click the clock icon.

VERSION TIMELINE — paragraph 1:

↑ top

Versions · paragraph 1

[Close]

- CURRENT
Somewhere in La Mancha, in a place whose name I do not care to remember...

— Apr 17 · 11:42am

Somewhere in La Mancha — a place I'd rather not name — a gentleman lived not so long ago...

[Restore this version]

— Apr 16 · 9:15pm

In La Mancha, somewhere, a man lived.

[Restore this version]

— Apr 15 · 3:30pm

There was a man in La Mancha.

[Restore this version]

nothing is deleted — every draft is recoverable

Click **Restore this version** to go back. The current text becomes a new version — nothing is permanently lost.

Chapter 8 — Project Notes

Press `Ctrl+P` to open a scratchpad attached to the active project. Type freely — it saves automatically. Press `Esc` to close.

The note does not appear in the Explorer, is not compiled, and has no versions. It's a side table next to your writing desk.

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Chapter 9 — Baraja and Cut-up

Baraja takes a paragraph you've written and **mixes it with a random paragraph from elsewhere in the project**. This is the cut-up technique — automated collision, writer decides what stays.

BEFORE BARAJA:

session "Chapter One"

Somewhere in La Mancha,
in a place whose name
I do not care to remember,
a gentleman lived not
long ago...

session "The Knight"

Our gentleman was
approximately fifty years
old; his complexion was
weathered, his flesh
scrawny, his face gaunt.

↓ right-click → Shuffle (Baraja) ↓

AFTER BARAJA — the two collide:

Somewhere in La Mancha, his complexion was weathered,
his flesh scrawny — in a place whose name I do not
care to remember, a gentleman lived not long ago,
one of those who has a lance and ancient shield on
a shelf. A very early riser and a great lover of the hunt.

something new appeared. you didn't plan it.

Right-click any paragraph → **Shuffle (Baraja)**.

If the result doesn't interest you: right-click the session in the Explorer → **Undo shuffle**.

When to use Baraja

- When a paragraph feels stuck
- When you want unexpected connections between sessions
- When the logical next sentence is the last thing you want to write

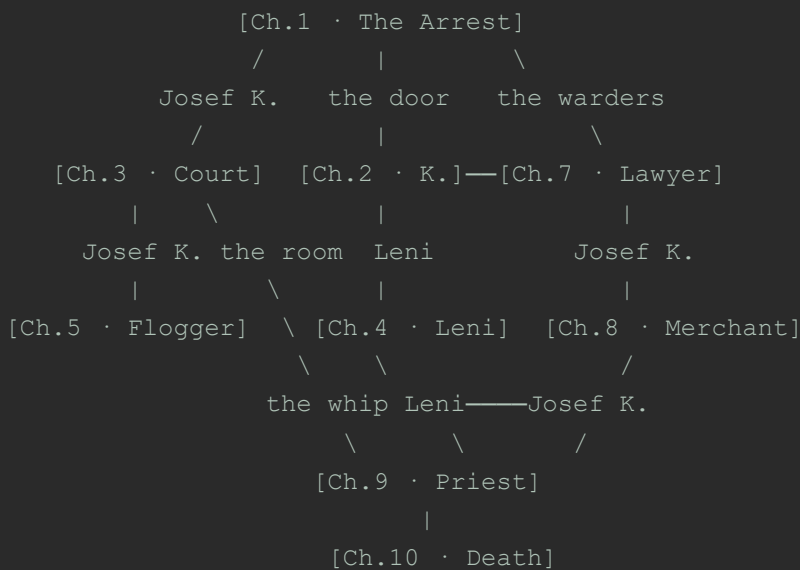
*Baraja is not a random generator. It is a **prompt from your own writing** — everything it pulls comes from text you already wrote.*

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Chapter 10 — Graph View

A visual map of your project. Paragraphs as nodes, connections you draw manually. In the Explorer, click the **Graph** tab.

GRAPH VIEW — The Process · Objects & People:



click any node → opens paragraph in Editor

Ctrl+click multiple → opens all together

- Click + **New graph** to create one (you can have multiple per project)
- Add nodes from your sessions
- Click one node then another to connect them
- Click any node to open that paragraph in the Editor
- Hold **Ctrl** and click multiple nodes to open them together

Chapter 11 — Tag System

↑ top

Tags are Gombro's semantic tracking system. Mark a word with `#` and Gombro follows it across all sessions — in the editor, the Explorer, and the Graph.

Creating a tag

Type `#word` directly in the editor. The word appears **bold** and slightly larger. Gombro registers it as a project tag automatically on save.

You can also add tags from the Graph search box — type the word and press **Enter** or **+**.

Tags in the editor

Any `#word` is displayed visually highlighted. The formatting is visual only — it does not appear when exporting to `.docx` or `.md`.

Click a tagged word to search for it in the Explorer and, if the Graph is open, highlight the corresponding node.

Searching by tag in the Explorer

Click any tag chip in the Explorer. Results show each occurrence with **KWIC context**: the 3 words before, the tagged word, the 4 words after.

```
... the ingenious gentleman Quixote of La Mancha ...
```

Results also include sessions whose **title** contains the word.

Click any result to navigate directly to the paragraph in the editor.

Tags and the Graph

The Graph shows project tags as nodes connected to the paragraphs that contain them. Each project has a single Graph — tags are shared across both views.

Click a tag chip in the Graph to filter nodes. Click a `#word` in the editor to have the Graph highlight the corresponding node and zoom to it.

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Deleting a tag

Click the ✕ on the chip in the Graph. The tag is blacklisted — it won't reappear even if `#word` remains in the text.

To reactivate it, search for it in the Graph search box and press Enter.

Automatic propagation

When you create a new tag, Gombro searches all project sessions and registers it wherever it appears — without you having to open each session.

ACTION	HOW
Create tag	Type <code>#word</code> in editor or Graph search box
View occurrences with context	Click tag chip in the Explorer
Highlight in Graph	Click <code>#word</code> in the editor
Filter nodes in Graph	Click tag chip in the Graph
Delete tag	✕ on the chip in the Graph
Open tags panel	<code>/tag</code> in CmdBar

Chapter 12 — Import and Export

Importing

Click `[↑]` in the Explorer header. Accepts `.txt`, `.md`, `.docx`. Each paragraph/section becomes a session in a new project.

Exporting

```
compile
compile Don Quixote — First Draft
```

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All visible sessions, in Explorer order, exported as a single `.docx` file to

`Documents/gombro/{projectName}/`.

Chapter 13 — Floor 13

This chapter was intentionally left blank for superstitious reasons. If you are reading this, nothing bad has happened. Yet.

Chapter 13b — Borgian Algebra

Borgian Algebra is Gombro's system for writing with open alternatives — inspired by the way Borges corrected his manuscripts: not erasing, but **branching**.

Inserting a pending fragment

1. Click anywhere to position the cursor (or select a word/phrase)
2. Right-click → **Insert**
3. Type your text in the panel — multiple lines supported
4. Press **ok** (or `Ctrl+Enter`) to insert as a pending Borgian block

If you close the panel without pressing ok, nothing is inserted. The block stays pending until you confirm it.

INSERT FLOW:

cursor here ↓

...a gentleman lived | not long ago...

right-click → Insert

| in a place I'd rather forget, | ← type here

↑ top

[ok]

press ok (or Ctrl+Enter)

result — pending block inserted inline:

...a gentleman lived

in a place I'd rather
forget,

not long ago...

(pending — confirm or leave open)

Creating a variant from a selection

1. Select any word or phrase
2. Right-click → **Add variant**
3. Type the alternative and press

The selected text becomes the first option. Your new text becomes the second. Both appear as a visual block:

SELECT → right-click → Add variant:

...the dog was [dead]

↓

type alternative: "alive"

↓

...the dog was

dead
alive

← original

← new variant

...still barking

add more variants anytime → right-click block → Add variant

Editing an existing variant

To change the text of an existing variant you have two options:

- **Double-click** on the variant row — opens the input directly with the current text pre-loaded.
- **Right-click → Edit this variant** — same result.

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Edit the text and press `Ctrl+Enter` to confirm. The variant is replaced in the block without creating a new one.

Adding sub-variants

You can branch a specific option inside a borgiana block — creating a variant of a variant. This reproduces the tree structure of Borges' manuscripts: each branch can bifurcate into new branches.

1. Right-click on a specific row in the block
2. Choose **Add sub-variant**
3. Type the alternative and press `Ctrl+Enter`

The chosen option becomes a new nested block with two branches — the original and the new one:

SUB-VARIANT — branching an existing option:

the dog was walking	← right-click → Add sub-variant
the dog was coming	

↓

the dog was walking	← nested sub-block
the dog was trotting	
the dog was coming	

Internal syntax: {the dog was coming|{the dog was walking|the dog was trotting

There is no depth limit — each branch can keep bifurcating.

Resolving a branch

RESOLVING — Borges style (crossed out, not erased):

right-click "dead" → Choose this:

↑ top

dead	→	dead	← chosen
alive		~~alive~~	← struck (still visible)
unconscious		~~unconscious~~	

right-click → Confirm (collapse) → plain text: "dead"
the alternatives disappear only when YOU decide.

Right-click any row inside the block:

ACTION	EFFECT
Choose this	Strikes through all other options
Strike this	Marks this option as discarded
Confirm (collapse)	Collapses the block to plain text (if one option alive)

Struck options remain **visible** — like Borges' crossed-out words. They don't disappear until you confirm.

Syntax

Internally stored as `{option1|option2|~~struck~~}`. You never see this while writing — the editor renders the visual block automatically.

The philosophy

*Borgian Algebra is a way of **holding contradictions open** — of writing a text that contains its own alternatives without forcing a resolution.*

Borges wrote: "Time forks perpetually toward innumerable futures." Borgian Algebra is the word processor that believes him.

The Diary is a special project that Gombro maintains separately from your writing projects. One session per day, named automatically with the date. Press `Ctrl+D` from anywhere to open it.

EXPLORER — diary always last:

▸ PROJECT: Don Quixote	
La Mancha	
The Knight	
▸ PROJECT: DIARIO	← always at the bottom
Wed, 22 April, 26	← today (auto-created)
Tue, 21 April, 26	
Mon, 20 April, 26	

How it works

- `Ctrl+D` from anywhere — opens today's session, creating it if it doesn't exist
- Session names are literary dates: *Wed, 22 April, 26*
- `Ctrl+N` is disabled in diary mode — one session per day, created automatically
- At midnight, Gombro auto-switches to the next day's session
- Available via slash menu: type `/` → *diary* or *diario*

FLOW:

Press `Ctrl+D` anywhere

↓

Is today's session open?

YES NO

↓

stay
there

↓

auto-create
"Wed, 22 Apr, 26"

↓

open in editor

↓

write freely — saved automatically

↓

midnight → tomorrow's session opens

↑ top

The diary is not a project — it is a habit. Gombro keeps it out of the way of your fiction, always at the bottom of the list, always one keystroke away.

Chapter 13d — Schrödinger Mode

In 1935 Erwin Schrödinger described a cat locked in a box: without opening the box, the cat is simultaneously alive *and* dead. Only when observed does it collapse into one of the two states.

Gombro's Schrödinger Mode applies that logic to text: some fragments are not yet one thing or the other. They exist on the page — but they haven't been decided.

What is quantum text?

A paragraph is in Schrödinger state when it contains any of these:

TYPE	HOW IT LOOKS	WHAT IT MEANS
Strikethrough	struck-through text	Marked for possible deletion — not decided yet
Borgian variant	<code>{option A option B}</code>	Text in superposition — two possible futures, uncollapsed

The strikethrough says: *"this might be too much."*

The variant says: *"this could be this, or that."*

Neither is final. The text remains open.

How to strikethrough text

Select any fragment → right-click → **Strikethrough**. The text stays visible but crossed out.

```
| ...in a place in La Mancha, whose name  
| ~~I do not care to remember~~, not long ago... |
```

↑ top

```
↑ the editor shows visual strikethrough;  
the ~~ markers are hidden but saved
```

Then right-click on the struck-through text:

Delete	← removes the fragment entirely
Edit	← removes strikethrough, text becomes editable

Edit is the Borgian option: you don't erase the thought, you transform it. Write the replacement, press Enter — the text stays clean with no strikethrough.

The ✨ Schrödinger button

At the bottom of the Explorer, above the Collections, the Schrödinger button is always visible:

session 1	
session 2	
session 3	
✨ Schrödinger [3]	← yellow badge = pending paragraphs
📁 my collection	

- The **badge** updates automatically when you switch projects or save
- **Click** to see the list of paragraphs in quantum state
- Click any result to jump directly to it in the editor

The Schrödinger list

Clicking ✨ shows pending paragraphs grouped by session — same UI as search results:

✨ Schrödinger [3]	[X close]	↑ top
Chapter One		

~~I do not care to remember~~, not long...

Chapter Two

...there lived a hidalgo {of the lance|with
a lance} in the rack...

Epilogue

~~This part is redundant~~ · The story...

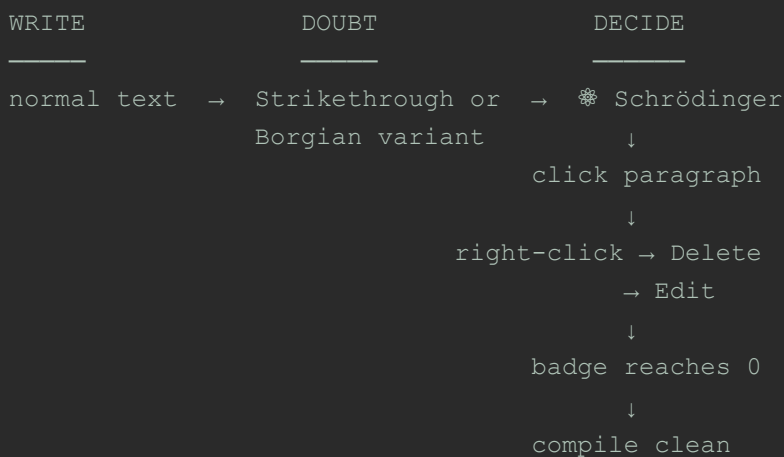
Schrödinger and compile

When you compile to `docx` or `md`, Gombro scans the project. If there are Schrödinger paragraphs, a notice appears before generating the file:

✿ 3 paragraphs in Schrödinger state
(strikethroughs or unresolved variants)

You can still compile — it is just a reminder. Struck-through text will appear struck through in the docx; uncollapsed Borgian variants will appear in their raw form.

The full workflow



Borges crossed out but never erased. He kept the discarded text visible — proof that the thought had been there. Schrödinger Mode is exactly that: a space for doubt before decision.

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Reference

ACTION	HOW
Strikethrough selection	Select → right-click → <code>Strikethrough</code>
Delete strikethrough	Right-click struck text → <code>Delete</code>
Edit strikethrough	Right-click struck text → <code>Edit</code> → type → Enter
View pending paragraphs	Click <code>Schrödinger</code> in the Explorer
Keyboard shortcut	<code>Ctrl+Q</code>
Command	<code>schrodinger</code> in the CmdBar

Chapter 13e — Writing Plan

The Writing Plan is a dashboard that shows how much you've written — today, this week, and over the past months. It's not a productivity tool. It's a mirror.

How to open it

Type `/` in the CmdBar and select **Writing plan** (or **Plan de escritura** in Spanish). The panel appears on the right side of the Explorer.

What it shows

- **Today** — words written today, with an optional daily goal. Click `set` to define your goal.
- **This week** — a bar chart of the last 7 days.
- **Weeks** — weekly totals for the past months.
- **Months** — monthly totals.

The daily goal

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You can set a daily word goal. Gombro counts every word you write in the active project. When you reach the goal, the bar fills up. There is no alarm, no notification — just a quiet record.

A writing plan is not a deadline. It is a habit made visible.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Open Writing Plan	Click <code>/plan</code> in the CmdBar
Set daily goal	Click <code>set</code> next to the Goal field
Close panel	Click <code>×</code> in the panel header

Chapter 13f — Session Notes and Badges

Every session in the Explorer can have its own note — a free-form annotation visible at a glance. A small badge () appears on sessions that have notes, so you can tell at a glance which sessions have context attached.

How to add a note to a session

1. Right-click the session name in the Explorer.
2. Select **Annotate session**.
3. A small panel opens. Type your note.
4. The note saves automatically.

Notes can also be anchored to specific paragraphs using `F4` while writing.

The badge

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Sessions with at least one note show a  badge in the Explorer. This lets you mark sessions that need attention, have context, or are works in progress — without opening them.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Add note to session	Right-click session → <code>Annotate session</code>
Add note to paragraph	<code>F4</code> while cursor is in the paragraph
View all notes	<code>/note list</code> in the CmdBar

Chapter 13g — Hashtag Filtering in the Explorer

If your project uses hashtags, you can filter the session list by hashtag directly from the Explorer — no need to open the search panel.

How it works

At the bottom of the Explorer, your project hashtags appear as small tags. Click one to show only sessions that contain that hashtag. Click again to remove the filter.

This is useful when a project has many sessions and you want to focus on sessions related to a specific theme, character, or location.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Filter by hashtag	Click the hashtag tag in the Explorer
Remove filter	Click the active hashtag again ↑ top

Chapter 13h — Text Scale

You can adjust the size of the text in the editor without changing the font or the style. This is purely for reading comfort — like the zoom level in a word processor.

How to change the scale

Type `/scale` (or `/escala` in Spanish) in the CmdBar. Enter a number between 50 and 300. The number represents a percentage: `100` is the default size, `125` makes text 25% larger, `80` makes it smaller.

```
/scale 125    → larger text (25% above default)
/scale 80     → smaller text (20% below default)
/scale 100    → back to default
```

The setting is saved automatically and persists when you reopen Gombro.

This does not change the font, the line height, or the style of headings. It only scales the base size — like moving closer or farther from the page.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Change text scale	<code>/scale [50-300]</code> in the CmdBar
Reset to default	<code>/scale 100</code>

Chapter 13i — Obsidian Notebook

Obsidian is a note-taking application for writers and thinkers. It stores notes as plain text files (`.md`) on your computer — no cloud, no subscription required. You can download it for free at obsidian.md.

If you use Obsidian alongside Gombro, the **Obsidian Notebook** lets you bring your Obsidian notes into your writing project automatically.

How the connection works

Obsidian and Gombro both run on your computer. Gombro finds your Obsidian vault automatically — you don't need to configure any paths or settings.

The connection is based on **hashtags**. If your Gombro project is called *Kolon*, Gombro will look for Obsidian notes that contain `#kolon`. Each matching note appears in the Obsidian Notebook panel.

Typical workflow

1. You're out, reading, thinking. You open Obsidian on your phone or laptop and write a note: *"The colonel's uniform touches the ground when he walks. #kolon"*
2. Back at your desk, you open Gombro and open the Kolon project.
3. A notification appears: **"You have new notes in Obsidian."**
4. You type `/obsidian` in the CmdBar. The Obsidian Notebook opens.
5. You see the note. You copy it into your session. Done.

The Obsidian Notebook panel

- Shows only **new or modified** notes since the last time you checked.
- Each note has two buttons:  **Copy** (copies content to clipboard, removes from view) and  **Dismiss** (marks as read — won't appear again unless the note changes in Obsidian).
- Click **Actualizar / Refresh** to re-scan the vault.

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Multiple projects

The hashtag is derived from the project name automatically. Project *Quixote* → looks for `#quixote`. You can use multiple hashtags in a single Obsidian note to send it to multiple projects.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Open Obsidian Notebook	<code>/obsidian</code> in the CmdBar
Copy a note	Click  — copies to clipboard, removes from view
Dismiss a note	Click  — marks as read, won't reappear
Refresh	Click Actualizar in the panel
Download Obsidian	obsidian.md (free)

Chapter 13j — Backup and Recovery

Gombro stores everything in a single SQLite file: `gombro.db`. Backup means copying that file. Recovery means replacing it with an older copy.

How it works

Automatic backup — every time you close Gombro, a backup is saved automatically. No configuration needed.

Manual backup — type `backup` in the CmdBar at any time to save a snapshot immediately.

Recovery — type `recover` in the CmdBar to open the backup list. Select any entry and click **Restore selected**.

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Where backups are stored

By default, backups go to a folder called `backup_gombro` next to the database file:

```
%AppData%\gombro\backup_gombro\  
gombro-2026-04-29_10-00-00.db  
gombro-2026-04-30_09-15-00.db
```

Changing the backup folder

Open the recovery modal (`recover`) and click **Change...** — a native folder dialog opens. Choose any folder: Dropbox, Google Drive, an external drive. The setting is saved and applies to all subsequent backups, including auto-backups on close. You can change it at any time.

Backup rotation

Gombro keeps the **10 most recent backups**. When a new one is created and the count exceeds 10, the oldest is deleted automatically.

Restoring a backup

1. Type `recover` in the CmdBar.
2. Select a backup from the list.
3. Click **Restore selected**.

Gombro closes the database, replaces it with the chosen backup, and reloads all data immediately. No restart needed.

Reference

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>backup</code>	Save a snapshot now
<code>recover</code>	Open backup list and restore

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Chapter 14 — Recommended Workflow

From blank project to exported draft — a suggestion, not a rule.

Phase 1 — Open the instrument

```
create project Don Quixote  
new La Mancha
```

Write until the session is done, then create another. Don't organize yet.

Phase 2 — Let chance work

Pick a paragraph that feels stuck. Right-click → Baraja. Keep what surprised you. Undo what didn't work. Use **Sentence Mode** when you want to slow down.

Phase 3 — Tag and map

Tag recurring elements. Open the Graph, build a visual map of connections.

Phase 4 — Search and collect

Search for elements to track. Save useful searches as Collections. Use Paragraph Versions to compare and restore.

Phase 5 — Export

Arrange sessions in the Explorer in the order you want. Then:

```
compile Don Quixote — First Draft
```

Open the `.docx` for final formatting and submission.

Keyboard Shortcuts

SHORTCUT	ACTION
<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>	Open CmdBar
<code>Ctrl+T</code>	Open floating command palette
<code>Ctrl+F</code>	Open floating search
<code>Ctrl+N</code>	New session (disabled in diary mode)
<code>Ctrl+D</code>	Open today's diary session
<code>Ctrl+Q</code>	Schrödinger mode — view paragraphs with quantum text
<code>F4</code>	Toggle post-it note for active session
<code>F1</code>	Open Help
<code>Esc</code>	Close CmdBar → close Search → toggle Zen
<code>F2</code>	Rename selected session in Explorer
<code>Delete</code>	Delete selected session (or all multi-selected)
<code>↑ ↓</code>	Navigate sessions in Explorer
<code>Enter</code>	Open selected session in Explorer
<code>Ctrl+click</code>	Multi-select sessions in Explorer
<code>Shift+click</code>	Select range of sessions in Explorer

About the Author

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Raúl Lilloy is the creator of Gombro. He believes writing should be an act of discovery, not production. He built the tool he wanted to use — no cloud, no AI, no agenda.



"Writing is... I don't know.
That's why I write."

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